coordination is required, Sangh communicates through swayamsevaks working in these organisations, by giving advice whenever demanded.'[112]

For the Sangh, these structural linkages mean that activists are exposed to, and come to be converted to, the Sangh's world view during the course of their work. It sees the Parivar organisations, therefore, as a 'conveyor belt of Sangh ideas in society'.[113]

Parallelly, Sangh ideologues see organisations like the ABVKA as a way of re-engineering society into their own ideal. According to Ambekar, 'different sectors—farmers, workers, students—may be discrete units, but they are not separate silos. There are inherent linkages and mutual coordination which results in a nation-building vision. This is known as "Sangh-samanvay", or coordination, essential in society. As Swami Vivekanand said in his speech at Madurai, "There are three stages necessary for the future of India. The whole secret lies in organisation, accumulation of power and coordination of wills." In the Sangh's life, the first two stages are already true. We are in the third stage and the Sangh is working on the coordination of wills.'[114]

There is no question that the RSS, and its multiple affiliated organisations, are a major political force multiplier for the BJP. Under Vajpayee's prime ministership, the party was sensitive to public criticism of its RSS link. The Gujarat government of Keshubhai Patel lifted the ban on RSS members joining the bureaucracy in January 2000, but was forced to withdraw after Prime Minister Vajpayee faced immense criticism in Parliament. There was strong opposition in Gujarat, with Amarsinh Chaudhary, leader of the Congress, terming it a blatant attempt to 'saffronise the bureaucracy which has so far remained largely free from communal bias'.[115] The issue then grew into a wider crisis for Vajpayee's coalition government as the Opposition brought in a censure motion. Keshubhai initially refused to back down, but his hand was forced by the BJP top brass after Vajpayee, it is said, threatened to resign if the censure passed in Parliament.[116] In sharp contrast to this, there have been no controversies about the RSS link under the Modi regime, which wears its Sangh lineage proudly.